

PRE-READ / BEFORE SATURDAY

Build agents that earn their keep.

*Come to Saturday with one honest
operational bottleneck named — and
Hermes ready to work on your machine.*

WHAT YOU WILL BUILD

One agent that explains what
shipped in your codebase.

One that finds investors who
fit your round and drafts
outreach for your review.

Saturday is for building. This
is the setup work that
protects the time.

Start with the work that keeps stealing your week.

You will build two specific agents on Saturday. The more useful skill is the pattern underneath them: identify a repeated task, give an agent the right inputs and guardrails, and keep a human in control of the important action.

What is the one operations task – not your product, the work around it – that is consuming time right now?

Sales & business development Outreach, lead research, follow-up	Hiring & talent Screening, scheduling, drafting rejections
Investor relations Updates, outreach, relationship tracking	Marketing & content Competitor watching, repurposing
Product & customer feedback Support triage, reviews, synthesis	Finance & legal ops Invoicing, expenses, renewals

YOUR WORKING NOTE – SAVED ONLY IN THIS BROWSER

My domain

e.g. Investor relations

The specific task

e.g. Preparing a weekly investor update

How often it happens

e.g. Every Friday

Do the wiring now. Build with it on Saturday.

01 / Install Install Hermes

The installer handles its own Python, Node.js, and dependencies. You need Git already installed; Linux also needs `curl` and `xz-utils`.

```
curl -fsSL https://raw.githubusercontent.com/NousResearch/hermes-agent/main/scripts/in
```

On Windows, use PowerShell:

```
iex (irm https://hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/install.ps1)
```

Open a fresh terminal when it completes, then verify:

```
hermes --version
```

02 / Model Connect direct OpenAI API access

1. Create an API key at platform.openai.com/api-keys.
2. Add it to `~/.hermes/.env`: `OPENAI_API_KEY=sk-...`
3. Set your provider and model in `~/.hermes/config.yaml`. The provider id is `openai-api`, not `openai`.

```
model:
  provider: "openai-api"
  default: "gpt-5.6-sol"
```

```
hermes model
hermes status
```

03 / Telegram **Give your agent a remote-control channel**

1. Message **@BotFather** in Telegram and send `/newbot`. Keep the bot token it returns.
2. Message **@userinfobot** or **@get_id_bot** to find your numeric Telegram user ID.
3. Run the gateway setup and enter both values.

```
hermes gateway setup
```

Start it, leave it running, then message your bot: *"Hello Hermes. Reply in one sentence and tell me what tools are active."*

```
hermes gateway
```

04 / Checkpoint **Confirm your agent is alive**

- ☐ `hermes status` shows your provider and model.
- ☐ Your Telegram DM gets a response.
- ☐ A web-search prompt works.
- ☐ `hermes memory status` runs without error.
- ☐ The final test below gives a coherent answer.

Final test — send this exact message:

“Give me a one-paragraph setup report: model, tool route, channel, memory, and one thing still missing.”

Use the symptom to find the right fix.

hermes: command not found

 after install +

Install fails on macOS

 +

Provider not authenticated, or the OpenAI key is not used

 +

SSL: CERTIFICATE_VERIFY_FAILED

 , an unknown issuer, or a self-signed certificate +

API call failed after 3 retries: Connection error

 +

Hermes asks for a different provider or says a credential is exhausted

 +

A new chat works but an old chat still shows errors or outdated advice

 +

Telegram does not respond

 +

Arrive ready to build.

☐ Hermes installed and checkpoint-tested.

☐ Access to a GitHub repository with recent commits, if possible.

☐ A rough fundraising round: stage, sector, geography, target check size.

☐ Your laptop, charger, and your Part 1 answer.

See you Saturday, 10am.

Keep this page open while you set up. Your progress stays in this browser only.